

AI for Small Business Owners

A simple, repeatable system for finding where AI can save your business time and money - and turning one of those opportunities into your first working AI workflow.



THE PROMISE

You do not need to become an AI expert. You need to know where AI belongs in your business, what context it needs, and which workflow is worth testing first.

What exactly do you get?

This is not another list of “100 prompts.” It is a working system that takes you from identifying an expensive repetitive task to testing your first useful AI workflow.

AI OPPORTUNITY AUDIT

Find repeatable work across sales, support, marketing, operations, and admin.

AUTOMATION SCORECARD

Prioritize tasks by frequency, time, repeatability, risk, context, and business value.

BUSINESS CONTEXT FILE

Build one reusable source of truth covering your company, offers, customers, tone, FAQs, and rules.

PROMPT LIBRARY

Use prompts for thinking, writing, organizing, planning, reviewing, leads, support, content, and reporting.

SAFETY CHECKLIST

Know what is safe to start with, what needs review, and what should stay out of AI systems.

7-DAY PLAN

Go from audit to a tested workflow without turning this into a six-month “AI project.”

AGENT BLUEPRINT LIBRARY

Seven repeatable workflow recipes you can test manually first and automate later.

AI IMPLEMENTATION MAP

Finish with a business case: opportunities, estimated time saved, owners, difficulty, and next steps.

ONE SYSTEM

Find → Prepare → Build → Implement. Everything in the workbook supports one of those four decisions.

Don't read this workbook cover to cover.

This is a working document for your business. Choose the path that matches the amount of time and involvement you have right now.

1

FAST TRACK

30 MIN

Owner completes the opportunity audit, scores five tasks, and chooses one workflow to test.

2

TEAM WORKSHOP

60-90 MIN

Use the audit with sales, support, marketing, and operations to identify opportunities across the company.

3

7-DAY IMPLEMENTATION

15-30 MIN / DAY

Work through the complete system and test one workflow on real business examples.

YOUR JOB

Answer three questions: Where is my team losing time? Which task could AI help with? What is the first workflow worth testing?

From “AI sounds interesting” to one working workflow

You do not need to know which tools or agents to buy before you understand the business problem.

STEP 01

FIND THE MONEY LEAK

Audit repetitive work and identify where your team spends expensive human time on repeatable tasks.

STEP 02

BUILD THE CONTEXT

Give AI the information it needs about your business, customers, offers, tone, FAQs, processes, and guardrails.

STEP 03

CREATE THE WORKFLOW

Use the 7-box workflow model, prompts, and blueprints to test one AI-assisted process on real examples.

WHAT YOU GET

You leave with one prioritized workflow.

WHAT YOU GET

You stop getting generic output.

WHAT YOU GET

You get a repeatable process, not a demo.

Forget “AI agents” for a minute.

Imagine a very fast assistant. It can read, summarize, compare, classify, draft, recommend, and repeat the same process every time - but only if you give it a clear job.

CONTEXT

What does it need to know about your business?

INSTRUCTIONS

What exactly should it do?

INPUT

What information will it work with?

RULES

What may it never assume, decide, or send?

OUTPUT

What should it return, and in what format?

THE SIMPLE MODEL

AI becomes useful when the input and output are clear, the business context is available, and a human knows what to review.

What AI should - and should not - do first

Your safest first workflow is useful, repeatable, and easy to review before anything important happens.

GOOD STARTING POINTS

- ☐ Draft a first version
- ☐ Summarize information
- ☐ Classify or route requests
- ☐ Extract facts from documents
- ☐ Compare options
- ☐ Research and prepare briefs
- ☐ Turn notes into structured output
- ☐ Create reminders and follow-up drafts

DON'T START HERE

- ☐ Final financial decisions
- ☐ Legal decisions
- ☐ Sensitive HR decisions
- ☐ Sending important messages without review
- ☐ Unrestricted access to business systems
- ☐ Handling passwords or payment details
- ☐ Processes nobody can explain clearly
- ☐ High-stakes actions with no rollback

Use your team. You do not need to fill in every page yourself.

Each section can be owned by the person closest to the information. The workbook works better as a company diagnostic than as CEO homework.

OWNER

Decide priorities, risk, investment, and which business process is worth improving.

TEAM

Document FAQs, examples, recurring tasks, existing processes, and source material.

BUILD

Test prompts, map the workflow, define review rules, and decide what to automate later.

RULE OF THUMB

If the answer lives in someone else's head, inbox, CRM, or process - delegate that page to them.

Find where your business is paying humans to do repeatable work

Do not ask “What can AI automate?” yet. First find the work that repeats.

SALES

- ☐ Replying to inquiries
- ☐ Qualifying leads
- ☐ Writing follow-ups
- ☐ Preparing proposals
- ☐ Updating CRM
- ☐ Meeting notes
- ☐ Sales reporting

CUSTOMER SERVICE

- ☐ Repetitive questions
- ☐ Order updates
- ☐ Complaints
- ☐ FAQs
- ☐ Routing requests
- ☐ Summarizing customer history

MARKETING

- ☐ Social content
- ☐ Emails/newsletters
- ☐ Repurposing content
- ☐ Research
- ☐ Reporting
- ☐ Performance reviews
- ☐ Creative briefs

OPERATIONS

- ☐ Internal reports
- ☐ Document summaries
- ☐ SOP creation
- ☐ Data entry
- ☐ Meeting follow-ups
- ☐ Internal questions
- ☐ Project status updates

ADMIN

- ☐ Booking
- ☐ Document organization
- ☐ Reminders
- ☐ Inbox triage
- ☐ Supplier research
- ☐ Recurring forms

DO THIS FIRST

Tick anything your business does every week. You are looking for patterns, not perfect numbers.

Repetitive Task Audit

List recurring tasks without judging whether AI can help. Capture the work first.

TEAM

15 MIN

Task	Times / month	Minutes each	Who does it?

GOAL

See how much invisible operational work is made up of small, repetitive steps that rarely appear in a strategy deck.

Put a number on the work

Choose five tasks from the audit. Approximate is good enough - we are looking for expensive patterns.

OWNER

10 MIN

Task	Hours / month	Value of 1 hour	Cost / month

WHAT COULD HAPPEN DURING THIS TIME INSTEAD?

Sales, customer conversations, product development, strategic work, or simply more time away from the business.

FRAME IT

Hours spent × approximate value of one hour = a business cost. The number does not need to be accounting-perfect to be useful.

Use the AI Opportunity Map

Frequency tells you whether the saving matters. Complexity tells you how much judgment and human review the process needs.

		LOW FREQUENCY	HIGH FREQUENCY
COMPLEX / HIGH JUDGMENT	LOW PRIORITY	Rare and complex. Leave it alone for now.	AI-ASSISTED Frequent but complex. Keep a human in the loop.
	NICE TO HAVE	Simple but rare. Improve later.	AUTOMATE FIRST Frequent and repeatable. Best starting zone.
SIMPLE / LOW JUDGMENT			

START IN THE BOTTOM-RIGHT

High-frequency + simple/repeatable tasks are usually the best first workflows. Avoid starting with the most impressive idea.

Automation Scorecard

Score each process from 1 to 5. The best first workflow is not simply “easy” - it is frequent, measurable, reviewable, and worth something to the business.

1. FREQUENCY

How often does this happen?

1 = rarely • 5 = every day

2. TIME

How much human time does it consume?

1 = tiny • 5 = substantial

3. REPEATABILITY

Does the process follow a similar pattern?

1 = different every time • 5 = highly repeatable

4. DIGITAL INPUT

Is the information already available digitally?

1 = mostly offline • 5 = readily available

5. LIMITED JUDGMENT

Can AI handle most of the task without making high-stakes decisions?

1 = expert judgment • 5 = straightforward

6. REVIEWABILITY

Can a person check the output before action?

1 = hard to review • 5 = easy to review

7. CLEAR OUTPUT

Can you describe what “done” looks like?

1 = vague • 5 = specific format/result

8. BUSINESS VALUE

Would improving this save meaningful time, money, or response speed?

1 = little value • 5 = high value

SCORING

32–40 = excellent first workflow • 24–31 = good candidate, human review needed • 16–23 = assist, do not automate yet • below 16 = leave it for now

Score your top five opportunities

Use a 1–5 score for each criterion. Add the eight numbers for a maximum score of 40.

OWNER + TEAM

15 MIN

Task	Freq.	Time	Repeat.	Digital	Judg.	Review	Output	Value	/40

BEST CANDIDATE

TIE-BREAKER

If two tasks score similarly, choose the one with the simpler input, clearer output, and easiest human review step.

STOP. Pick ONE workflow.

Do not automate seven things. Everything from this point forward is built around one process.

OWNER

5 MIN

YOUR FIRST AI WORKFLOW IS

TODAY THIS PROCESS TAKES APPROXIMATELY hours / month

CURRENT OWNER

IF IMPROVED, THIS COULD SAVE APPROXIMATELY hours / month

APPROX. VALUE / MONTH

WHY THIS PROCESS MATTERS TO THE BUSINESS

WHAT DOES "BETTER" LOOK LIKE?

COMMITMENT

From now on, use this one real process as your example. You are building a business workflow - not learning AI in theory.

Your first 10-minute AI win

Experience value before doing more setup. Use one real example from the workflow you just selected.

BUILD**10 MIN****1****Open the AI tool you already have**

ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, Copilot, or another approved tool.

2**Use one real example**

Paste a real inquiry, email, note, transcript excerpt, or task input. Remove sensitive information if needed.

3**Give AI a simple job**

Use the starter prompt below. Do not try to automate anything yet.

4**Compare the result**

Would this draft/analysis save time if someone on your team reviewed it?

STARTER PROMPT

You are helping me improve a repetitive business process. I will give you one real example. First, summarize what you think the task is trying to achieve. Then produce a useful first draft or analysis. Do not invent missing facts. List anything you need me to clarify. End with 3 ways this task could be made more repeatable.

THE GOAL

Not perfection. You are looking for evidence that AI can remove part of the work when a person supplies context and reviews the result.

Was the first AI attempt useful?

Record what happened. The gaps you identify here will tell you what business context and rules AI needs next.

OWNER / TEAM

5 MIN

USEFUL

Would you use any part of the result?

☐

1

☐

2

☐

3

☐

4

☐

5

ACCURATE

How much correction did it need?

☐

1

☐

2

☐

3

☐

4

☐

5

TIME SAVED

Did it reduce effort?

☐

1

☐

2

☐

3

☐

4

☐

5

REPEATABLE

Could this work on similar examples?

☐

1

☐

2

☐

3

☐

4

☐

5

WHAT WAS MISSING OR WRONG?**WHAT CONTEXT WOULD MAKE THE NEXT ATTEMPT BETTER?**

Generic AI gives generic answers.

Your Business Context File is a reusable source of truth that helps AI understand how your company actually works.

COMPANY

Who you are and how the business makes money.

OFFER

What you sell, pricing rules, boundaries, and outcomes.

CUSTOMER

Who buys, why they buy, objections, and questions.

VOICE

How your brand communicates and what it should avoid.

KNOWLEDGE

FAQs, examples, SOPs, past decisions, and approved source material.

RULES

What AI may not decide, claim, disclose, or send without review.

IMPORTANT

You do not need to create all of this from scratch. Most companies already have the information - it is simply scattered across websites, documents, inboxes, CRMs, and people.

The AI Context Hunt

Before writing anything manually, collect the business information you already have.

DELEGATE

20 MIN

- | | |
|---|--|
| ☐ Website copy | ☐ Offer / proposal PDFs |
| ☐ Sales presentations | ☐ Customer emails |
| ☐ FAQ documents | ☐ Customer reviews |
| ☐ Sales call transcripts | ☐ SOPs and procedures |
| ☐ Brand guidelines | ☐ Product descriptions |
| ☐ Previous campaigns | ☐ Common objections |
| ☐ Internal instructions | ☐ Meeting notes |
| ☐ CRM fields / qualification rules | ☐ Reporting templates |

WHERE WILL THESE FILES LIVE?

OUTPUT

One folder or document location the team can maintain. AI does not need “more information.” It needs the right information in one place.

Company in one screen

Give AI the minimum context needed to understand what kind of company this is and what matters commercially.

OWNER

10 MIN

COMPANY / BRAND NAME

WHAT DO WE SELL?

HOW DO CUSTOMERS BUY FROM US?

WHAT ARE THE 3 MOST IMPORTANT BUSINESS GOALS RIGHT NOW?

WHAT MAKES US DIFFERENT FROM ALTERNATIVES?

Offer and commercial rules

AI should know what you sell - and what it must never invent about the offer.

OWNER + SALES

15 MIN

MAIN OFFER / PRODUCT

BEST-FIT CUSTOMER FOR THIS OFFER

CORE OUTCOME / VALUE

PRICING, PACKAGES, OR PRICING RULES AI MAY REFERENCE

WHAT AI MUST NEVER PROMISE OR INVENT

Customer context

The goal is not a fictional persona. Capture what your team repeatedly sees in real conversations.

SALES + SUPPORT

15 MIN

WHO USUALLY BUYS FROM US?

WHAT USUALLY TRIGGERS THEM TO LOOK FOR A SOLUTION?

WHAT PROBLEMS COST THEM THE MOST TIME OR MONEY?

WHAT OUTCOMES DO THEY WANT?

WHAT WORDS OR PHRASES DO CUSTOMERS USE TO DESCRIBE THE PROBLEM?

Brand voice and communication rules

Give AI examples and boundaries so it sounds like your company - not a generic assistant.

MARKETING

10 MIN

WE SHOULD SOUND LIKE...

WE SHOULD NOT SOUND LIKE...

WORDS / PHRASES WE USE OFTEN

WORDS / PHRASES WE AVOID

PASTE 2-3 EXAMPLES OF COMMUNICATION THAT SOUND EXACTLY RIGHT

Approved FAQs

These are answers AI can use as reference material. Keep them factual and approved by the person responsible for the topic.

SUPPORT / SALES

20 MIN

Customer question	Approved answer / source

Sales objections and decision rules

Capture what the team hears repeatedly and how you want AI to handle it.

SALES

15 MIN

Objection / concern	Approved response / angle	Escalate when...

Process and decision rules

AI needs to know what the normal process is, where exceptions happen, and which decisions remain human.

OWNER + PROCESS OWNER

15 MIN

DESCRIBE THE CURRENT PROCESS IN 5–10 STEPS

WHAT INFORMATION MUST ALWAYS BE PRESENT?

WHAT SITUATIONS ARE EXCEPTIONS?

WHAT DECISIONS MUST STAY HUMAN?

What information can AI see?

Use a simple traffic-light rule before putting business information into any AI tool. Follow your company's policies and the tool's data settings.

GREEN

Usually easier to start with

- ☐ Public website information
- ☐ Marketing copy
- ☐ Product descriptions
- ☐ Public reviews
- ☐ General process descriptions
- ☐ Non-sensitive examples

YELLOW

Check policy / remove identifiers

- ☐ Internal reports
- ☐ Customer communication
- ☐ Performance data
- ☐ Internal procedures
- ☐ Commercial information
- ☐ Non-public documents

RED

Keep out unless explicitly approved

- ☐ Passwords / credentials
- ☐ Payment information
- ☐ Sensitive personal data
- ☐ Private HR information
- ☐ Confidential legal material
- ☐ Secrets / restricted data

WHEN IN DOUBT

Remove identifying information or ask the person responsible for privacy, security, legal, or compliance in your company.

Assemble your Business Context File

You can paste this structure into a document and keep improving it over time. It becomes reusable context for many future workflows.

TEAM

30 MIN

BUSINESS CONTEXT FILE

1. COMPANY

- What we do:
- How we make money:
- Current goals:

2. OFFER

- Main products / services:
- Best-fit customer:
- Pricing / commercial rules:
- Claims AI must never make:

3. CUSTOMER

- Typical buyer:
- Main problems:
- Desired outcomes:
- Common objections:

4. VOICE

- We sound like:
- We avoid:
- Approved examples:

5. KNOWLEDGE

- FAQs:
- Source documents:
- SOPs / examples:

OPTIONAL: paste your combined context file here or keep it in a separate company document.

Is your context file good enough to use?

Do not aim for completeness. Aim for enough trustworthy context to improve one workflow.

- ☐ The company and offer are described in plain language.
- ☐ AI has approved facts and examples - not only marketing claims.
- ☐ Customer language and common objections are included.
- ☐ Brand voice includes both positive and negative examples.
- ☐ The selected workflow has a documented current process.
- ☐ AI knows which decisions remain human.
- ☐ Sensitive information and credentials are excluded.
- ☐ There is a named person responsible for keeping this context current.

CONTEXT OWNER

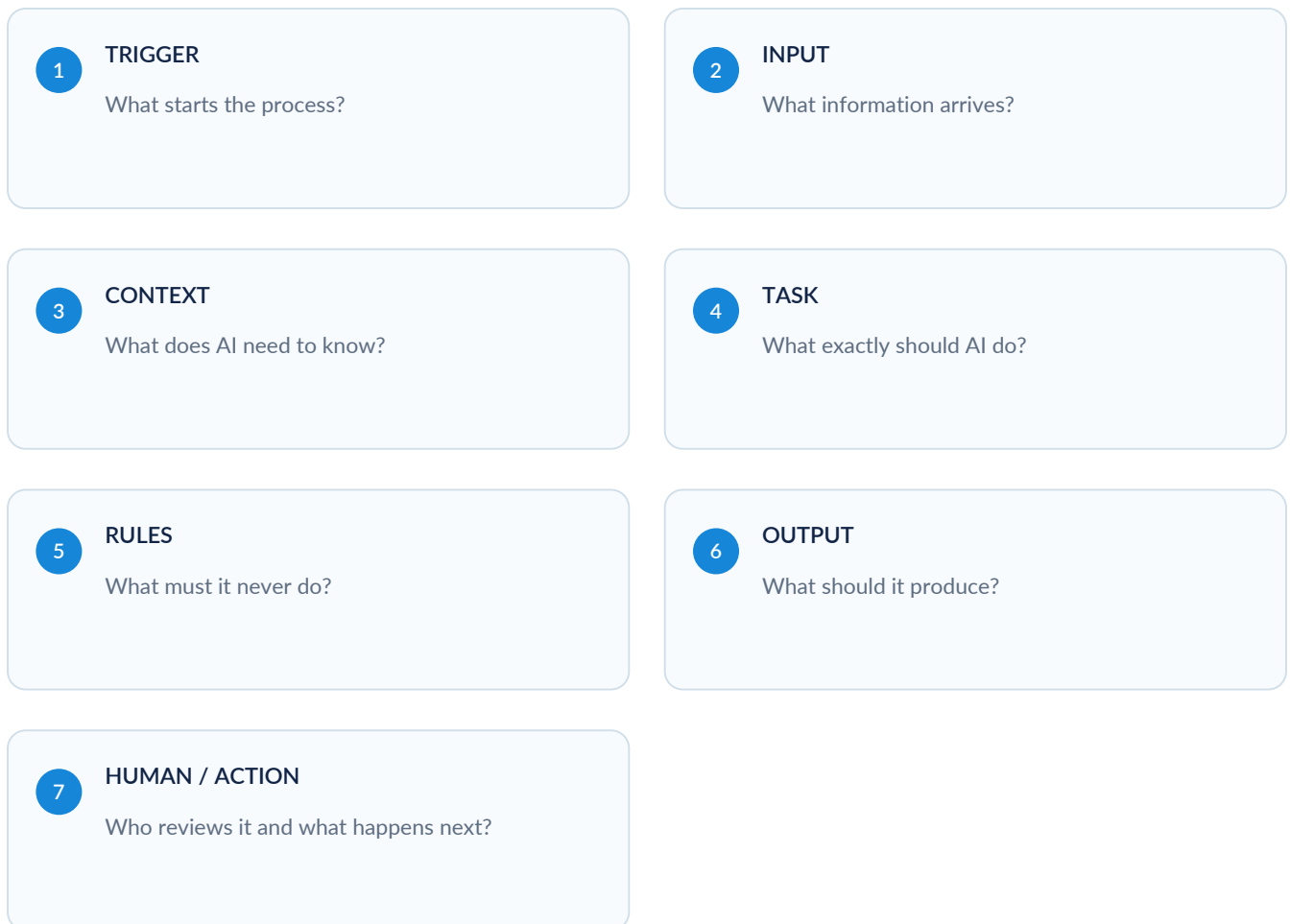
NEXT REVIEW DATE

GOOD ENOUGH

If the context materially improves the AI output on your chosen workflow, move on. You can refine the file after testing.

The 7 boxes every AI workflow needs

This model works whether the process is completely manual, semi-automated, or eventually turned into an AI agent.



WHY THIS WORKS

If you cannot describe these seven boxes clearly, automation will usually create more confusion rather than less work.

Build your first AI workflow

Use the same process you selected in Part 1. Keep it simple enough to test manually before connecting any tools.

BUILD

20 MIN

1. TRIGGER

What starts this process?

2. INPUT

What information does AI receive?

3. CONTEXT

Which parts of the Business Context File matter?

4. TASK

What exactly should AI do?

5. RULES

What must AI never assume, decide, or send?

6. OUTPUT

What should the result look like?

7. HUMAN / ACTION

Who reviews it and what happens next?

Example: AI Lead Follow-Up Assistant

This is deliberately simple. The same workflow can start as copy/paste and become automated only after the output is reliable.

TRIGGER

A prospect completes the website form.

INPUT

Name, company, service, budget range, problem, message.

CONTEXT

Offer, ideal customer, qualification criteria, common objections, tone.

TASK

Summarize the lead, assess fit, identify missing information, recommend next step, draft a reply.

RULES

Do not invent pricing. Do not promise results. Flag ambiguity. Do not send anything automatically.

OUTPUT

Lead summary + fit score + missing questions + recommended next action + draft response.

HUMAN / ACTION

Salesperson reviews the recommendation and sends or edits the response.

MANUAL FIRST

Copy one real lead into AI and run this process 10–20 times before connecting the form, CRM, email, or Slack.

AI before automation

You can create substantial value at Level 1. Do not jump to agents just because they sound more advanced.

LEVEL 1**AI-ASSISTED****START HERE**

Person copies the input into AI. AI prepares a draft or analysis. A person reviews it.

LEVEL 2**SEMI-AUTOMATED****NEXT**

Information is sent to AI automatically, but a person still approves the result before action.

LEVEL 3**AUTOMATED****LATER**

AI produces or triggers actions using clear rules, logging, and exception handling.

LEVEL 4**AI AGENT****ADVANCED**

AI can choose between multiple tools or actions to achieve a defined objective within guardrails.

REMEMBER

You do NOT need Level 4 to start getting value from AI. Complexity should be earned by a proven business case.

Choose the right implementation level

Decide what makes sense now - not what sounds most impressive.

☐**LEVEL 1 • AI-ASSISTED**

We can test this manually with copy/paste and human review.

☐**LEVEL 2 • SEMI-AUTOMATED**

We have a repeatable process and want the input to flow automatically.

☐**LEVEL 3 • AUTOMATED**

The rules are proven and actions can be automated safely.

☐**LEVEL 4 • AGENT**

The process genuinely requires AI to choose between tools/actions.

WHY IS THIS THE RIGHT LEVEL FOR NOW?

WHAT MUST BE TRUE BEFORE WE MOVE TO THE NEXT LEVEL?

A useful prompt is just the workflow written as instructions

You do not need clever wording. You need clear context, task, rules, and output.

ROLE

Who should AI act like for this task?

CONTEXT

What business information matters?

INPUT

What will you give it each time?

TASK

What should it do, step by step?

RULES

What must it not assume or decide?

OUTPUT

What exact format should it return?

REVIEW

When should it ask for clarification or flag uncertainty?

PROMPT QUALITY

If the result is inconsistent, improve context and rules before adding more words to the prompt.

Use AI to help you write the prompt

You do not need to become a prompt engineer. Use this meta-prompt whenever you are turning a business task into a reusable AI instruction.

I want your help improving an instruction for an AI assistant.

My desired business outcome is: [OUTCOME]

The process I am improving is: [PROCESS]

Before writing the final prompt:

1. Ask me the questions required to understand the task.
2. Identify missing business context.
3. Identify decisions AI should not make independently.
4. Recommend a useful output format.
5. Suggest how a human should review the result.
6. Then create the final reusable prompt.

Do not invent missing facts. If an important rule is unclear, ask me before finalizing the prompt.

YOUR IMPROVED PROMPT

Do not search for “the perfect prompt.” Start with the outcome.

Choose the category that matches what you need AI to do in the workflow.

THINK

Analyze • Compare • Identify problems • Recommend • Prioritize

WRITE

Reply • Follow up • Draft • Rewrite • Personalize

ORGANIZE

Summarize • Extract • Classify • Structure • Route

PLAN

Create workflow • Create SOP • Build action plan • Prepare brief • Create checklist

REVIEW

Find gaps • Check completeness • Challenge assumptions • Quality-control output • Flag risks

HOW TO USE THE LIBRARY

Each prompt tells you when to use it, what to give AI, and what output to expect. Adapt the context and rules to your company.

Prompts: leads and follow-up

Keep a human in control of pricing, commitments, unusual cases, and final customer communication.

LEAD QUALIFICATION

USE THIS WHEN

You receive inbound leads and need a fast first assessment.

GIVE AI

Lead details + ideal customer + qualification rules + offer context.

COPY / ADAPT

Review this lead against our qualification criteria. Summarize the request, rate fit from 1–5 with reasons, identify missing information, and recommend the next step. Do not invent facts or pricing.

EXPECTED OUTPUT

Summary + fit + missing questions + recommended action.

POST-CALL FOLLOW-UP

USE THIS WHEN

You need a useful follow-up after a sales or customer call.

GIVE AI

Call notes / transcript + offer context + agreed next steps + tone.

COPY / ADAPT

Turn these notes into a concise follow-up. Confirm the key problem, recap agreed actions, state who owns each next step, and draft the email. Flag any commitment that is not explicitly supported by the notes.

EXPECTED OUTPUT

Internal recap + customer-ready draft.

Prompts: email and customer support

Use approved FAQs and examples. AI should flag uncertainty rather than guess.

INBOX TRIAGE

USE THIS WHEN

You have many incoming emails and need to identify what matters.

GIVE AI

Email or thread + categories + priority rules.

COPY / ADAPT

Classify this message by topic and urgency. Summarize it in 3 bullets, identify the requested action, and recommend who should own it. If information is missing, state what is unclear.

EXPECTED OUTPUT

Category + urgency + summary + owner + next action.

SUPPORT REPLY DRAFT

USE THIS WHEN

A customer asks a common question covered by approved material.

GIVE AI

Customer message + relevant FAQ / policy + tone.

COPY / ADAPT

Draft a helpful reply using only the approved information provided. If the question is not fully covered, do not improvise; list the missing information and mark the reply for human review.

EXPECTED OUTPUT

Draft response + confidence / escalation flag.

Prompts: content and reporting

Use AI to turn existing expertise and data into structured drafts - not to manufacture authority you do not have.

CONTENT REPURPOSING

USE THIS WHEN

You have one strong long-form source and need channel-specific drafts.

GIVE AI

Transcript / article + audience + voice + channels.

COPY / ADAPT

Extract the 5 strongest ideas from this source. For each, explain why it matters to our customer. Then create channel-specific drafts using our voice. Do not add claims or statistics not present in the source.

EXPECTED OUTPUT

Ideas + rationale + drafts for selected channels.

WEEKLY BUSINESS SUMMARY

USE THIS WHEN

You collect recurring KPI / team notes and need a concise management summary.

GIVE AI

Weekly data + targets + previous period + priorities.

COPY / ADAPT

Summarize this week in five sections: wins, misses, changes vs previous period, issues requiring attention, and recommended decisions for next week. Separate facts from interpretation.

EXPECTED OUTPUT

Executive summary + decisions + open questions.

Prompts: SOP creation and quality review

These are especially useful for businesses where knowledge lives in people's heads or meeting recordings.

SOP FIRST DRAFT

USE THIS WHEN

A process exists but is undocumented.

GIVE AI

Transcript / notes + desired user + known rules.

COPY / ADAPT

Convert this source into a practical SOP. Include purpose, owner, trigger, required inputs, step-by-step procedure, exceptions, quality checks, and escalation points. Mark any assumptions as "NEEDS CONFIRMATION."

EXPECTED OUTPUT

Structured SOP draft + questions to confirm.

AI QUALITY CONTROLLER

USE THIS WHEN

You want a second pass before using an AI-generated output.

GIVE AI

Draft + original input + rules + approved facts.

COPY / ADAPT

Review the draft against the original input and rules. Identify unsupported claims, missing information, contradictions, risky wording, and anything that should be reviewed by a person. Do not rewrite until you list the issues.

EXPECTED OUTPUT

Issue list + corrected version + review flags.

Seven AI workflow blueprints

Treat these as recipes. Start manually, prove the output is useful, then decide whether connecting tools is worth it.

01

LEAD ASSISTANT

Qualify inquiries and prepare the next sales action.

02

FOLLOW-UP ASSISTANT

Turn calls and conversations into consistent next steps.

03

SUPPORT ASSISTANT

Draft replies using approved FAQs and policies.

04

CONTENT REPURPOSER

Turn one source into multiple channel-specific drafts.

05

MEETING ASSISTANT

Prepare briefs, notes, decisions, and actions.

06

WEEKLY REPORTER

Turn recurring data into a concise management summary.

07

SOP BUILDER

Turn real processes into documented procedures.

THE RULE

Automate later when you have tested enough real examples to know the input, output, rules, exceptions, and review step.

Blueprints: leads and follow-up

01 • AI LEAD ASSISTANT

What it does: Reads new inquiries and prepares the next sales action.

Good for: Businesses receiving enough inbound leads for response speed and consistency to matter.

You need: Lead form, offer context, ideal customer, qualification rules, tone.

AI job: Summarize → assess fit → identify missing information → recommend next step → draft response.

Human reviews: Pricing, unusual requests, commitments, final message.

TRY IT TODAY

Copy one real inquiry into AI using the Lead Qualification prompt.

AUTOMATE LATER WHEN...

You have tested at least 20 examples and the recommended actions are consistently useful.

02 • FOLLOW-UP ASSISTANT

What it does: Turns calls and conversations into consistent follow-up.

Good for: Sales, account management, consultations, service businesses.

You need: Call notes/transcript, agreed actions, offer context, tone.

AI job: Extract decisions → owners → deadlines → unresolved issues → draft customer follow-up.

Human reviews: Any commitment, pricing, scope, or sensitive issue.

TRY IT TODAY

Paste the notes from one completed call and compare the draft with how you normally follow up.

AUTOMATE LATER WHEN...

The call notes are reliably captured and the same output structure works repeatedly.

Blueprints: support and content

03 • SUPPORT ASSISTANT

What it does: Drafts replies to repeat customer questions from approved information.

Good for: Teams answering the same questions every week.

You need: FAQ, policy, tone, escalation rules, examples.

AI job: Classify question → retrieve approved answer → draft response → flag missing coverage.

Human reviews: Complaints, exceptions, refunds, legal or reputational risk.

TRY IT TODAY

Use 10 historical support messages and compare AI drafts with the approved replies.

AUTOMATE LATER WHEN...

AI consistently uses the right source material and escalates uncovered cases.

04 • CONTENT REPURPOSER

What it does: Turns one long-form source into multiple drafts.

Good for: Founder-led brands, expert businesses, lean marketing teams.

You need: Source content, audience, voice, channels, claims rules.

AI job: Extract ideas → prioritize relevance → adapt by channel → create drafts → flag unsupported claims.

Human reviews: Final publishing, claims, sensitive topics, brand nuance.

TRY IT TODAY

Paste one webinar/article/transcript and ask for 5 derivative pieces.

AUTOMATE LATER WHEN...

Your source library and brand context are organized enough to generate consistently useful drafts.

Blueprints: meetings and reporting

05 • MEETING ASSISTANT

What it does: Prepares meeting briefs and turns notes into decisions and action items.

Good for: Managers with recurring internal/client meetings.

You need: Calendar context, agenda, participant roles, previous notes, current priorities.

AI job: Prepare brief → summarize discussion → extract decisions → assign actions → identify unresolved issues.

Human reviews: Sensitive people topics, ambiguous commitments, final assignments.

TRY IT TODAY

Use one meeting transcript and compare the result with your manual notes.

AUTOMATE LATER WHEN...

Meeting notes are captured reliably and the output format is stable enough for your task system.

06 • WEEKLY REPORTER

What it does: Turns recurring KPIs and team updates into a management summary.

Good for: Companies with weekly scorecards, sales reports, campaigns, or operational metrics.

You need: Targets, current data, previous period, priorities, definitions.

AI job: Compare → identify material changes → explain likely causes → list issues → recommend decisions/questions.

Human reviews: Interpretation, missing data, financial decisions, accountability conclusions.

TRY IT TODAY

Paste this week's numbers and notes into the Weekly Summary prompt.

AUTOMATE LATER WHEN...

Inputs are standardized and managers trust the distinction between facts, interpretation, and recommendations.

Blueprint 07 + Tool Stack Planner

07 • SOP BUILDER

What it does: Turns real work into a documented procedure that a team member can follow.

Good for: Companies where processes live in people’s heads, chats, or meeting recordings.

You need: Transcript/notes, process owner, known rules, exceptions, quality criteria.

AI job: Extract steps → organize sequence → name owners/inputs → add quality checks → flag assumptions.

Human reviews: Accuracy of process, exceptions, compliance, final approval.

TRY IT TODAY

Take one process explanation and generate a first SOP draft.

AUTOMATE LATER WHEN...

You have several stable processes and want SOP generation to become part of normal operations.

TOOL STACK PLANNER

Choose the simplest tools required for the workflow. Avoid buying software before you have proven the manual AI-assisted version.

Workflow	AI tool	Business tool	What each tool does

AI Safety Checklist

Before a workflow becomes normal business practice, make sure the process is controlled, reviewable, and appropriate for the information involved.

- ☐ We know what information enters the AI tool.
- ☐ Sensitive or restricted information is removed or explicitly approved.
- ☐ The AI is instructed not to invent missing facts.
- ☐ Important customer-facing messages have a human review step.
- ☐ Pricing, legal, financial, HR, and high-stakes decisions remain human.
- ☐ The workflow has a named owner.
- ☐ There is a clear escalation path when AI is uncertain.
- ☐ Outputs can be checked against an approved source.
- ☐ We have tested multiple real examples - not only one demo.
- ☐ The team knows how to stop or bypass the workflow if needed.
- ☐ Tool permissions are no broader than necessary.
- ☐ We will review quality and errors after launch.

SAFE ENOUGH TO TEST

The goal is not zero risk. The goal is clear boundaries, human control where it matters, and a process that can fail safely.

Your first workflow in 7 days

Keep the project small enough to finish. The outcome is one tested workflow and a decision about what to do next.

DAY 1**Find the money leak**

Choose one process with measurable time/cost.

DAY 2**Document today**

Map the current process and collect real examples.

DAY 3**Build context**

Create the minimum Business Context File for this workflow.

DAY 4**Create AI-assisted version**

Write the prompt/workflow using the 7-box model.

DAY 5**Test on 5 real examples**

Record usefulness, accuracy, and corrections.

DAY 6**Improve rules + review**

Fix failure modes and define what remains human.

DAY 7**Decide the next level**

Keep manual, delegate, automate, or get implementation help.

DAY 7 IS A BUSINESS DECISION

You are not trying to “finish AI.” You are deciding whether this workflow should stay assisted, be owned by your team, become automated, or be implemented with specialist help.

Your AI Implementation Map

Use this page to turn the workbook into a business case. Capture the best opportunities, who owns them, and what implementation level makes sense.

Process	Hours/mo	Value/mo	Owner	Level	Difficulty

POTENTIAL HOURS SAVED / MONTH

APPROXIMATE VALUE / MONTH

PROCESSES READY TO TEST

PROCESSES NEEDING IMPLEMENTATION HELP

THIS IS YOUR BRIEF

If you bring only one page into an implementation conversation with your team or an external partner, bring this one.

Does the workflow actually help?

Measure the business effect after implementation. AI output quality matters, but so do time, speed, consistency, and team adoption.

Metric	Before	Week 1	Week 4	Notes

WHAT IMPROVED MOST?

WHAT STILL CREATES FRICTION?

WHAT SHOULD WE CHANGE NEXT?

You found the opportunities. Now choose how to implement them.

The workbook has done its job if you can see where AI belongs in your business, what one workflow needs, and what should happen next.

1

OPTION 1 • DO IT YOURSELF

Best when the process is simple, one or two tools are involved, and human review is easy. Keep using the blueprints and test manually.

2

OPTION 2 • GIVE IT TO YOUR TEAM

Best when someone internally can own testing, documentation, quality review, and tool setup.

3

OPTION 3 • BUILD IT WITH SUPPORT

Best when you identified several valuable processes but need help with integrations, architecture, context, permissions, reliability, or implementation.

MY NEXT ACTION

WORKFLOW OWNER

DECISION DATE

IMPLEMENTATION CONVERSATION

Use your completed AI Implementation Map as the starting brief - not a blank “tell us about your business” call.